

7 - PPA Draft & Planning

Lesson 7 - PPA Draft & Planning

Interesting things

This week:

Several London councils thought be affected by cyber-attacks



A stylised stock image of a laptop keyboard and a hand typing.

Several London councils are believed to have been targeted in cyber-attacks within the past few days.

The Royal Borough of Kensington & Chelsea (RBKC) said that it and Westminster City Council were "responding to a cyber incident affecting some shared IT systems" and that some some systems, including phone lines, were disrupted.

RBKC said two councils were working with cyber specialists and the National Cyber Security Centre to protect data and restore services and apologised for disruption. The Met Police is investigating.

Hammersmith & Fulham Council said in a memo it had experienced a "serious cyber security incident" and that it was "working to fix the problem as quickly as possible".

RBKC said the issue was identified quickly on Monday and that emergency plans had been activated so that critical services could still be delivered.

The statement added it was investigating the ongoing incident and would provide information when it was available.

"We would like to apologise for any disruption and thank residents for their patience as we work to bring systems back online safely," it said.

[On its website](#), the council said it was "too early to say who did this, and why, but we are investigating to see if any data has been compromised".

The Information Commissioner's Office has been notified, RBKC said.

According to the LDRS sources, some systems at RBKC have been down for two to three days.

The Hammersmith and Fulham Council memo suggested its issues were connected with the incident affecting RBKC and Westminster councils.

It said a few connectivity issues remained, but these could not be resolved until RBKC could guarantee its networks were safe, which could take some days.

It also urged staff not to click on any links sent from Kensington and Chelsea Council and Westminster City Council colleagues in Outlook or Teams accounts "until further notice".

A statement on Hammersmith and Fulham's website read: "We are continuing to take precautionary measures to review, isolate and protect our networks.

"We're working to fix the problem as quickly as possible and we apologise for the inconvenience."

The Met Police said it had received a referral from Action Fraud.

"Enquiries remain in the early stages within the Met's Cyber Crime Unit. No arrests have been made," the statement added.

'Critical' threat

Elsewhere, Hackney Council said its staff had been sent an urgent memo warning them against phishing attacks.

An official note seen by the LDRS stated: "We have received intelligence that multiple London councils have been targeted by cyber-attacks within the last 24-48 hours, with potential disruption to systems and services.

"Your immediate co-operation is essential to protect the council and the data of our residents."

The note said Hackney Council had raised its cyber security threat to "critical" and urged staff to help protect residents' data.

The east London council itself has not been targeted, the authority says.

'Better resilience'

Mayor of London Sir Sadiq Khan said he was unaware of the attacks when asked by the LDRS earlier on Tuesday.

However, he said City Hall was helping councils build better cyber-resilience to learn lessons from previous the attacks like the ones on [Transport for London](#), Marks & Spencer and Heathrow Airport.

He said: "We are trying to encourage councils to have better resilience but the reality is, I'm afraid, those who breach protections are going to try more and more ways to get into those systems."

Hackney Council [was hit by a serious cyber attack in 2020](#) that led to criminals gaining access to and encrypting 440,000 files, affecting at least 280,000 residents and other individuals including staff.

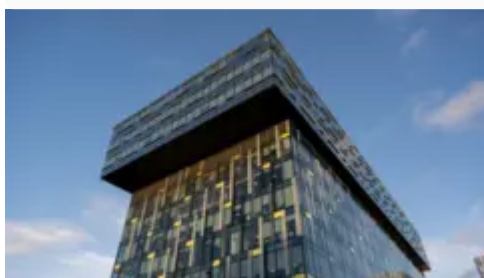
The Information Commissioner's Office reprimanded the council last year over the incident, saying it found "examples of a lack of proper security and processes to protect personal data".

Correction November 26: A previous version of this story said Hackney Council had been affected, the story has now been updated to say it has not and that staff had been sent an urgent memo warning of an attack.

Listen to the best of BBC Radio London on [Sounds](#) and follow BBC London on [Facebook](#), [X](#) and [Instagram](#). Send your story ideas to hello.bbclondon@bbc.co.uk

More stories like this

- [TfL faces 'ongoing cyber security incident']
(<https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cd9dpek1883o>)



Palestra House, a modern glass building in Southwark

- [Hackney Council still addressing 2020 cyber attack]
(<https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cvg8dn28241o>)



The art deco Hackney Town Hall building with Hackney Town Hall across the front under a clock face, with two rows of windows across the facade.

- [Hackney Council services remain affected by hack]
(<https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/uk-england-london-54606375>)



Hackney council offices

Horror Stories you can learn from

British Library cyberattack - Wikipedia



Entrance gate to the British Library on Euston Road, St Pancras, London, looking towards the Newton statue

In October 2023, [Rhysida](#), a [hacker group](#), attacked the online information systems of the [British Library](#). They demanded a ransom of 20 [bitcoin](#), at the time around £ 596,000, to restore services and return the stolen data. When the British Library did not acquiesce to the demands, Rhysida publicly released approximately 600GB of leaked material online. Services at the library were severely disrupted for months. It has been described as "one of the worst cyber incidents in British history".^[1]

The main catalogue returned online on 15 January 2024 in a [read-only](#) format, although some of the library's services are expected to remain unavailable for months. The British

Library will use about 40 percent of its financial reserves, around £ 6–7 million, to recover from the attack.

Background

The [British Library](#) is a [non-departmental public body](#) which in 2023 held around 14 million books, as well as millions of other items.^{[2] [3]} It is the largest library in the United Kingdom.^[4] The Library was protected by [firewalls](#) and [antivirus software](#) but did not have a [multi-factor authentication](#) (MFA) policy that covered all organizational assets. The Library had installed a new Terminal Services server in February 2020 to facilitate [remote access](#) to third-party providers during the [COVID-19 pandemic](#); this was the server on which unauthorized access was first detected during the attack. The library had achieved accreditation for the "Cyber Essentials Plus" in 2019; however, in 2022 the accreditation standards changed which made the library non-compliant. In 2020, the Library, in light of the COVID-19 pandemic, implemented MFA, however, a Library report clarified that "...but for reasons of practicality, cost and impact on ongoing Library programmes, it was decided at this time that connectivity to the British Library domain (including machine log-on access and access to on-premise servers) would be out of scope for MFA implementation, pending further renewal of the Library's infrastructure."^[5] Due to these circumstances, the Library's servers were vulnerable to attack due to identified increasing third-party cybersecurity risks and a series of emergency decisions to quickly secure their infrastructure while adapting to change due to the COVID-19 pandemic. This sequence of identified potential security risks and the subsequent failure to remediate them is a classic example of the failure to maintain a strong organizational [Cybersecurity Risk Management](#) or Risk Remediation posture as outlined in [NIST SP 800-37r2](#).^[6]

[Rhysida](#) is a [hacker group](#) and " [ransomware as a service](#) " provider already known for its attacks on vital infrastructure such as schools, hospitals and government agencies, having become known to [intelligence services](#) in May 2023.^{[3-1] [7]} It had previously attacked the [Chilean Army](#), a medical research lab in Australia, and health-care company [Prospect Medical Holdings](#).^[7-1]

The British Library attack was part of a larger pattern of [cyberattacks](#) at this time against cultural institutions. These attacks had previously affected the [Metropolitan Opera](#) in [New York City](#) and [Natural History Museum](#) in [Berlin](#).^[8]

2023

- **28 October:** At 9:54 a.m. [GMT](#), The British Library states on [Twitter](#) that it is experiencing "technical issues affecting our website". By midmorning, issues include a public [Wi-Fi](#) outage and non-functional online catalogue.^{[7-2] [3-2] [9]}

- **29 October:** The Library announces on [Twitter](#) that it is experiencing a "technology outage".^[7-3]
- **30 October:** The Library reopens after the weekend "in a pre-digital state", according to [The New Yorker](#). Its website, phone lines, ticket sales, reader registrations, and card transactions are non-functional. Deliveries from the Library's [Boston Spa](#) site are put on hold.^[7-4]
- **31 October:** The Library confirms publicly that the outage is the consequence of a cyberattack.^[10] It launches an investigation alongside the [National Cyber Security Centre](#) (NCSC) and other [cybersecurity](#) specialists.^[11]
- **16 November:** An attempt at digital extortion, also known as a ransomware attack, is confirmed by the Library.^[10-1]
- **20 November:** Rhysida claims responsibility for the breach and launches a week-long auction for 490,191 files of data on the [dark web](#), opening bidding at 20 [bitcoin](#), at the time equivalent to about £ 596,000, for a single buyer.^{[2-1] [7-5]} It sets the auction deadline to 8 a.m. [GMT](#) on 27 November and advertises it with [low-resolution](#) images which appear to show [HM Revenue and Customs](#) documents, [employment contracts](#) and [passport](#) information.^{[2-2] [4-1]} It claims the data is "exclusive, unique and impressive".^[3-3] The Library states that the leaked data appears to be from its internal [human resources](#) files.^[4-2]
- **27 November:** Rhysida makes 90 percent of the stolen data, approximately 600 [GB](#), freely available for anyone on the [dark web](#) to download after the British Library refuses to pay the ransom.^{[7-6] [12]}

2024

- **5 January:** The Financial Times reports that the Library would use around 40 percent of its financial reserves to recover from the attack, estimated at around £6–7 million.^[13]
- **10 January:** The Library announces that some of its services will return online from 15 January, with access stated by [Roly Keating](#), chief executive of the Library, to be "slower and more manual" than before the attack. Keating apologises that "for the past two months researchers who rely for their studies and in some cases for their livelihoods on access to the library's collection have been deprived of it".^{[14] [15]}
- **15 January:** The British Library's main online catalogue is restored in a [read-only](#) format. Users are able to search the main catalogue, but the process of checking availability and ordering items is different. Access to key [special collections](#) is restored but for in-person visits only.^{[14-1] [15-1] [16] [17]}
- **8 March:** [Roly Keating](#) authors a blog post to the British Library website announcing the availability of a report that "gives a description and timeline of the attack, to the best of our current understanding, and its implications for the Library's operations, future infrastructure and risk assessment." ^{[18] [19]} The report announced that it was

undertaking a "Rebuild & Renew" scheme "to ensure its future ability to respond to incidents of a similar scale in a consistent and structured way", including a "considerable shift" away from on-site technologies and onto the [cloud](#).^[20]

- **30 July:** Library announces that remote ordering of physical media for delivery to the Reading Rooms will be available by September 2024. Digital versions of historically significant manuscripts will be re-released incrementally beginning in September, based on a "prioritised list of manuscripts based on criteria including the items that were most requested prior to the cyber-attack and items to which Reading Room access is restricted." Educational websites, and digital academic journals, will also be restored before the academic year 2024–25, to the extent possible. Digital ordering of items in the Automated Storage Building is expected to go back online in August 2024.^[21]

2025

- Access to the library collection will be halted between the 1st of December to 7th December to allow for a [LMS](#) changeover to the [Ex Libris](#) software Alma.^{[22] [23]}
- Following the changeover a new online catalogue interface will be available on the 8th December for requests.^[22-1]

Attack methods

The Library stated that the attackers probably used a [phishing](#), [spear-phishing](#) or [brute-force attack](#) facilitated by a compromise of third-party credentials as well as a lack of use of multi-factor authentication by third-party contractors. After gaining access, Rhysida used three methods to identify and copy the 600GB of documents during the attack, including personal details of Library users and staff. These were:^[20-1]

1. A targeted attack that copied full sections of [network drives](#) of the Library's Finance, Technology and People teams, which made up 60% of all content copied.
2. A keyword attack which scanned for files and folders that used sensitive keywords in their names, including 'passport' or 'confidential', which constituted 40% of the copied data and included files from [corporate networks](#) and personal drives used by staff.
3. A hijacking of native utilities, which were then used to forcibly create backup copies of 22 databases of data including contact details of external users and customers.

Furthermore, Rhysida and its affiliates destroyed servers to inhibit system recovery and [forensic analysis](#).^[20-2]

Impact

While the process of calculating the full financial impact of the attack is ongoing,^[20-3] there were a number of impacts to the functioning of the library following the attack. These include:

- Library items from its [Boston Spa](#) branch could not be transferred to the London site.^[9-1]
- Around 20,000 writers, illustrators and translators who usually received [Public Lending Right](#) payments from borrowed books had their payments delayed.^{[24] [9-2]}
- The Library's 2024–25 visiting fellowship programme was suspended.^[9-3]
- The computerised catalogue was offline for months, with partial restoration in January 2024.^[9-4]
- The [EThOS](#) collection of British [doctoral theses](#) remained offline as of 19 December 2023.^[7-7]
- An estimated £6–7 million in costs to recover from the attack.^[13-1]
- As of 4 November 2024, British Library electronic resources web pages redirect to a page with the statement, "We're continuing to experience a major technology outage as a result of a cyber-attack. Our buildings are open as usual, however, the outage is still affecting our website, online systems and services, as well as some onsite services. This is a temporary website, with limited content, which outlines the services that are currently available, as well as what's on at the Library."^[25]

See also

- [WannaCry ransomware attack](#)
- [Internet Archive cyberattack](#)

References

1. Ash, Lamorna (6 February 2024). ["Thanks to a shadowy hacker group, the British Library is still on its knees. Is there any way to stop them?"](#). *The Guardian*. ISSN 0261-3077. Retrieved 2024-02-22. ↩
2. Sherwood, Harriet (22 November 2023). ["Personal data stolen in British Library cyber-attack appears for sale online"](#). *The Guardian*. ISSN 0261-3077. [Archived](#) from the original on 2023-12-09. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩ ↩ ↩
3. Uddin, Rafe; Stacey, Stephanie (21 November 2023). ["Cyber attack on British Library raises concerns over lack of UK resilience"](#). *Financial Times*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2023-12-30. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩
4. Rufo, Yasmin (21 November 2023). ["British Library: Employee data leaked in cyber attack"](#). *BBC News*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩ ↩ ↩
5. <https://cdn.sanity.io/files/v5dwkion/production/99206a2d1e9f07b35712b78f7d75fbb09560c08d.pdf> ↩
6. <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-37r2.pdf> ↩
7. Knight, Sam (19 December 2023). ["The Disturbing Impact of the Cyberattack at the British Library"](#). *The New Yorker*. ISSN 0028-792X. [Archived](#) from the original on 2023-12-20. Retrieved 2024-01-16.

↩ ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩

8. Harris, Gareth (22 December 2023). ["As British Library faces fallout of cyber attack—what can arts bodies do to combat ransomware threats?"](#). *The Art Newspaper*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-14. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩
9. Sherwood, Harriet (15 January 2024). ["A 22-carat disaster': what next for British Library staff and users after data theft?"](#). *The Guardian*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-15. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩
10. Scropton, Alex (15 January 2024). ["British Library cyber attack explained: What you need to know"](#). *Computer Weekly*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩ ↩
11. Banfield-Nwachi, Mabel (31 October 2023). ["British Library suffering major technology outage after cyber-attack"](#). *The Guardian*. [ISSN 0261-3077](#). [Archived](#) from the original on 2023-11-08. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩
12. Adams, Geraldine Kendall (20 December 2023). ["Museums on alert following British Library cyber attack"](#). *Museums Association*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2023-12-23. Retrieved 2023-12-23. ↩
13. Uddin, Rafe; Thomas, Daniel (5 January 2024). ["British Library to burn through reserves to recover from cyber attack"](#). *Financial Times*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩ ↩
14. Gross, Jenny (15 January 2024). ["Months After Cyberattack, British Library Crawls Back Online"](#). *The New York Times*. [ISSN 0362-4331](#). [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩ ↩
15. Sherwood, Harriet (15 January 2024). ["British Library begins restoring digital services after cyber-attack"](#). *The Guardian*. [ISSN 0261-3077](#). [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩ ↩
16. Nanji, Noor (15 January 2024). ["British Library starts restoring services online after hack"](#). *BBC News*. [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-15. Retrieved 2024-01-15. ↩
17. Simpson, Craig (15 January 2024). ["British Library restoring online services after cyber attack"](#). *The Telegraph*. [ISSN 0307-1235](#). [Archived](#) from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩
18. Keating, Roly (8 March 2024). ["Learning lessons from the cyber-attack"](#). *Knowledge Matters blog*. British Library. Retrieved 2024-03-08. ↩
19. ["Learning from the cyber-attack: British Library cyber incident review"](#) (PDF). British Library. 8 March 2024. p. 18. Retrieved 2024-03-08. ↩
20. Coker, James (11 March 2024). ["Third-Party Breach and Missing MFA Led to British Library Attack"](#). *Infosecurity Magazine*. Retrieved 2024-03-12. ↩ ↩ ↩ ↩
21. ["Restoring our services – 30 July 2024 update"](#). *blogs.bl.uk*. ↩
22. Maxwell, Jamie. ["Guides: What's currently available: Introduction"](#). *bl.libguides.com*. Retrieved 2025-11-24. ↩ ↩
23. ["The British Library Selects Clarivate to Provide Library Services"](#). Retrieved 2025-11-24. ↩
24. Barnett, David (6 January 2024).. *The Observer*. [ISSN 0029-7712](#). from the original on 2024-01-16. Retrieved 2024-01-16. ↩
25. ["Sorry we can't find that page"](#). *British Library (bl.uk)*. Retrieved 2024-11-04. ↩

Capita plc and Capita Pension Solutions Ltd

- **Date 15 October 2025**
- **Type Monetary penalties**

The Information Commissioner's Office has fined Capita plc and Capita Pension Solutions Ltd a combined £14m following a cyber attack in April 2023 which saw hackers gain access to over 6m people's data.[Capita Plc And CPSL Monetary Penalty Notice](https://ico.org.uk/media/2/pv5nhks4/capita-plc-and-cpsl-monetary-penalty-notice.pdf)

[

PDF (1.05 MB)

](<https://ico.org.uk/media/2/pv5nhks4/capita-plc-and-cpsl-monetary-penalty-notice.pdf>)

The ICO report

Resources

Security Priorities 2025 - Info-Tech Research Group

1. Security Priorities 2025 Report – A data-driven report that reviews five priorities for security leaders in the upcoming year.

In this report, we provide five key priorities for IT leaders to combat the evolving cyber threat environment.

- Operationalize AI Security
- Strengthen Your Identity & Access Management Program
- Build a Resilient Vendor Risk Management Practice
- Defend Against Deepfake Attacks
- Prepare for the Post-Quantum Era

Prepare now for the cyberattacks of the future with Security Priorities 2025.



Security Priorities 2025 Report

Unlock This Blueprint

Your Challenge

AI has transformed the security landscape, and in 2025, IT leaders will need to protect against increasingly savvy threat actors. From dealing with typical attack vectors, such as phishing and credential capture attacks, to limitless possibilities for new vectors such as deepfakes and quantum computing, IT leaders will have to move far past reactive security. They will need to balance their approach and spend across the triad of people, process, and technology in the year to come.

The Security Priorities 2025 report highlights five key areas of focus in the fast-evolving security environment.

Our Advice

Critical Insight

Cyber threats are evolving rapidly. So should security priorities.

AI has transformed the security landscape, and in 2025, IT leaders will need to protect against increasingly savvy threat actors. From dealing with typical attack vectors, such as phishing and credential capture attacks, to limitless possibilities for new vectors such as deepfakes and quantum computing, IT leaders will have to move far past reactive security. They will need to balance their approach and spend across the triad of people, process, and technology in the year to come.

Impact and Result

Five priorities for the security agenda in 2025

Based on the results of our Info-Tech Future of IT 2024 survey and interviews, this report examines five key priorities that could transform your security efforts in 2025.

1. Operationalize AI Security

The era of AI is here. Are you ready to tap its potential?

The AI revolution promises great opportunities and risks for organizations seeking to improve their cybersecurity posture. In 2025, IT leaders will need to ensure that proper guardrails are in place to mitigate risk with AI adoption.

2. Strengthen Your Identity & Access Management Program

Safeguard your data with a modern approach to identity and access management.

AI has added a new tool to cybercriminals' belts – making identity-based attacks easier than ever before and more compelling. Block cybercriminals' advances with a modern identity & access management program built on zero-trust principles.

3. Build a Resilient Vendor Risk Management Practice

Establish a game-changing approach to mitigating third-party risk.

With new third-party breaches making the headlines at an increasingly worrisome rate, IT leaders know they must adopt a risk-based approach to vendor security. See the entire picture through to the finish line with stakeholder engagement and support.

4. Defend Against Deepfake Attacks

Perceptions of reality are evolving. So should your defense.

Deepfake attacks have altered reality – leaving employees in the dark about who to trust and where to turn in search of help. Shine a light on AI-powered attacks by developing a resilient incident-response plan powered by people, process, and technology.

5. Prepare for a Post-Quantum Era

Prepare now to protect against the technologies of tomorrow.

Advances in technology are bringing us closer to the post-quantum era: a time when encrypted data won't be as protected as it is now. Threat actors are preparing now to accelerate their attacks with quantum computing – how will you meet this new threat?

Unlock This Blueprint

Cyber Defence Alliance

About Us

Background

The Cyber Defence Alliance (CDA) was established in the UK in 2015 as a not-for-profit organisation by a coalition of four international banks with law enforcement support.

Since our formation, we have grown steadily and are entirely member owned and driven.

The CDA team comprises of permanent CDA staff and member secondees and is headquartered in Canary Wharf, London.

CDA Mission

Our mission is to generate and exchange intelligence and knowledge to:

- Reduce the impact of cyber attacks
- Counter the attacks of cyber threat actors and networks

- Increase the effectiveness of cyber security and cyber resilience efforts
- Provide timely and accurate insights of new and emerging cyber threats
- Work collaboratively with Telecommunication partners to identify and reduce threats

This is achieved by sharing resources, expertise and knowledge.

CDA Vision

The CDA provides a trusted environment for financial institutions to work in partnership with governments, law enforcement, intelligence, telecommunication operators and security agencies in the collective effort to fight for a better digital future.

Our work contributes to the online security, protecting the public from cyber threats, including the targeting of the most vulnerable in our society by sophisticated threat networks.

We work closely with regulators, national and regional authorities to respond to the evolution of cyber threats.

CMC – Cyber Monitoring Centre

In today's digital era, major cyber events pose an unprecedented threat to society and the economy. Yet, there is no commonly agreed-upon and understood system for objectively and consistently classifying these events.

The Cyber Monitoring Centre is an independent, non-profit organisation that will bring greater clarity to cyber events impacting UK organisations to enable better communication, preparation and response.

CYBER RESILIENCE CENTRE

NEBRC's Free Core Membership is more than an informative newsletter. Designed for SMEs from all different industries, we take you on a journey for upwards of 12 months to improve your business's cyber resilience. Included in our membership you will receive:

- Welcome Pack
- Monthly E-newsletter containing information about the latest threats and guidance relating to fraud and cybercrime
- Resources to help you protect yourself and your business against cyber threats
- Networking links to Police Cyber and Fraud Protection Officers – delivering a range of services locally

- Full briefing about our specialist cyber resilience services and how they can be tailored for you and your SME
- Up-to-date versions of the National Cyber Security Centre's guidance & complementary supplements
- A free risk check and bespoke recommendations to help you mitigate any risks you are under threat from

For a more detailed roadmap of the cyber security guidance you will receive as part of our Free Core Membership over the next 12 months, take a look at our helpful resource below.

Don't see a way to sign up? Your browser may be preventing the form from displaying. [Click here to try an alternative method.](#) If you are still encountering issues, please email us at enquiries@nebrcentre.co.uk.

Can I Learn Cyber Security On My Own?

Yes, you definitely can learn about cyber security on your own by utilising the wealth of cyber security advice and resources available online. At NEBRC, we offer a free membership that is designed to provide cyber security guidance for small businesses across the UK. Included in our free membership, you will receive:

- Updates on the latest cyber security threats with guidance
- Resources to help you protect yourself and your small business
- A free risk check for your SME
- Updated versions of NCSC guidance

What Can You Do to Improve Your Cyber Security?

To improve your cyber security the first step is to strengthen your awareness. Whether that be seeking personal cyber security guidance or training for your employees. A great way of improving your awareness is to access free resources and training. NEBRC's Free Core Membership provides you with an array of free resources, cyber security tips and guidance on a monthly basis.

Why is Cyber Security Important?

Cyber security is the process of protecting your internet-connected devices from hackers and cyber criminals. It is incredibly important because it puts measures in place to protect you from phishing schemes, ransomware attacks and hacks whereby sensitive data or financial information can be stolen.

NEBRC's Free Core Membership provides you with regular updates on common cyber attacks as well as useful resources. [Sign up](#) to learn how to protect yourself from cyber crime.

How Cyber Security Can Be Beneficial For Businesses?

Cyber security is beneficial for businesses because it puts security practices in place that allow for business continuity. Not only that, it creates trust with customers because they know you are protecting data as well as you can which can prevent serious issues down the line. Learn how to protect your business from cyber threats by signing up to our [Free Core Membership](#).

Companies that might be able to help:

Cyberis

Leading information security consultants based in the UK. Protect your brand, reputation, and data from cyber attack with our tailored cyber security solutions.

Customer focussed information security

As industry-leading information security consultants, we're experts in safeguarding the interconnected world we're living in. We're passionate about helping protect your brand, your reputation and your data. Our solutions will help you operate safely and securely.

[Get in contact](#) [More about us](#)

Top Solutions

Reassuringly clear thinking

We're trusted for our technical excellence, providing clients with a range of pioneering services to maintain and proactively strengthen their information security. Our expertise and

relentless curiosity combine to deliver customer specific solutions.



Pen Testing Illustration

Penetration Testing

We are a CREST-accredited penetration testing provider. Our pen testing services identify vulnerabilities and weaknesses in your infrastructure and applications – helping you take action to prevent data breaches and intrusions.

Find out how penetration testing can secure your business

[View original](#) Red Teaming



Red teaming illustration

Our Red Team emulate the tactics, techniques and procedures of adversaries who target your businesses. This simulation assesses your real-world resilience against cyber attacks – highlighting how well-equipped you are to detect and respond to an incident.

Learn how Red Teaming can build resilience

[View original](#) Cloud Risk Management



cloud padlock arrow

Whether you're moving on-premises systems to cloud hosting, developing cloud-hosted services or transforming your business to a zero-trust paradigm, we help you take advantage of cloud hosting's operational benefits while maintaining the security you need.

Discover how we enable your secure move to the cloud

[View original](#)

Sectors

Trusted with any security challenge

Experienced across all sectors, we work in close collaboration with our clients to really understand the precise risks they face. We'll transform valuable insights about your industry



into effective measures that deliver information security resilience.

Money in a circle

Financial Services

Learn more

[View original](#)Public Sector & Government



Building in circle

Learn more

[View original](#)Defence & Law Enforcement



Shield in circle

Learn more

[View original](#)Retail



Shopping basket in circle

Learn more

[View original](#)Technology



Technology icon

Learn more

[View original](#) Healthcare



Heart in circle

Learn more

[View original](#) Legal



Scales in circle

Learn more

[View original](#) SME



Shop in circle

Learn more

[View original](#) Education



Education har in circle

Learn more

[View original](#)



Colleagues discussing work

Lexonis

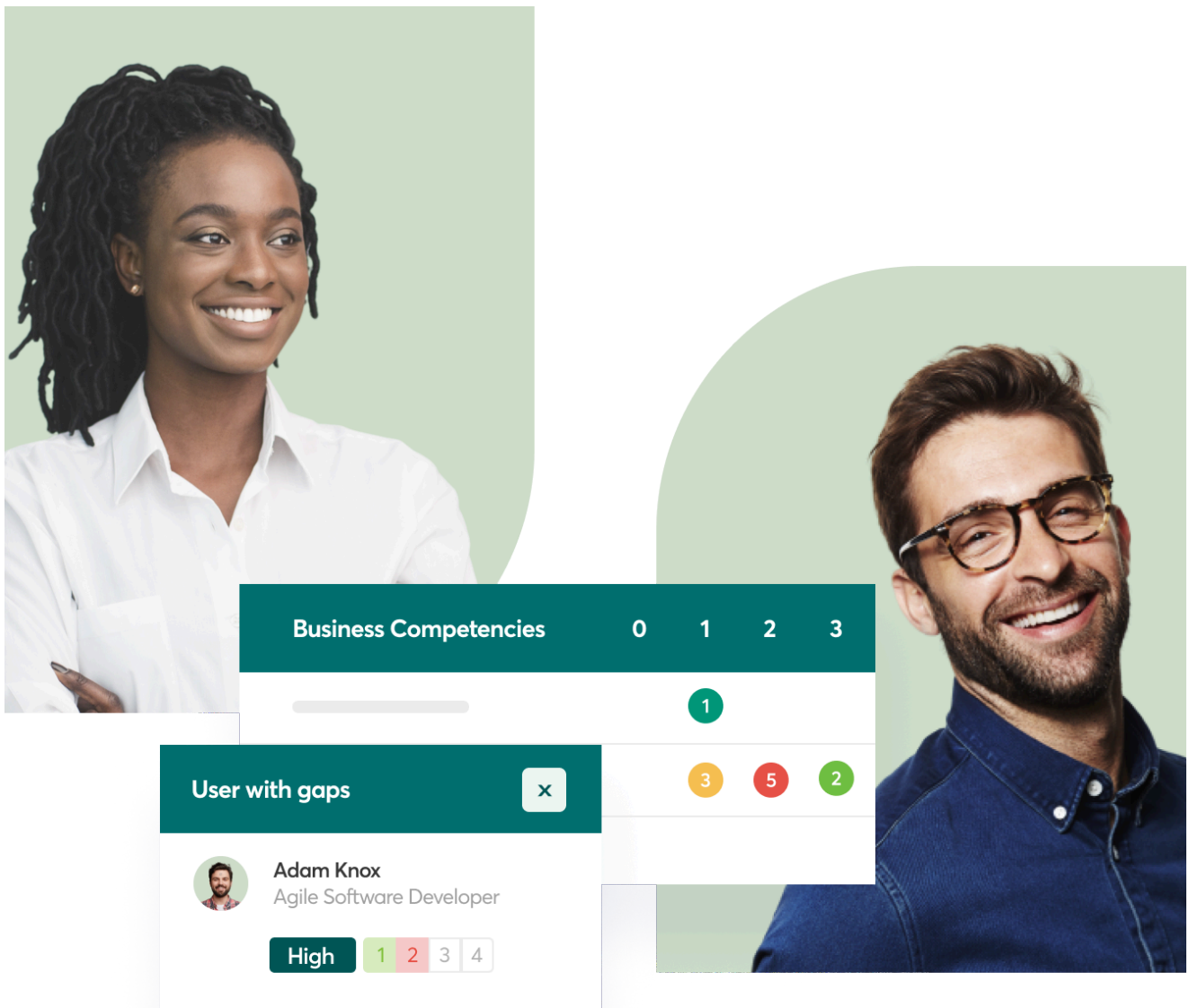
People Power Business Success

At the heart of every growing business are talented people. It's the skills, creativity and effort of these individuals that bring vision and growth to life. Lexonis' skills software platform, job and competency libraries and consulting services will help you do just that.

Whether you're an HR professional responsible for talent management or a CEO looking to enable and empower your workforce – prioritizing people is key to business success.

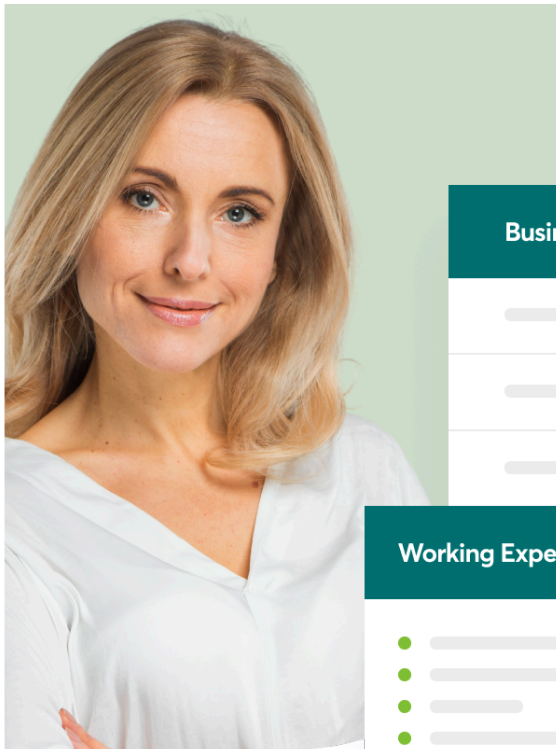
Lexonis have the solutions and the experience to show you exactly how to make it happen.

[Request a demo](#)



- **Maximize Your L&D ROI With Skills Insights**

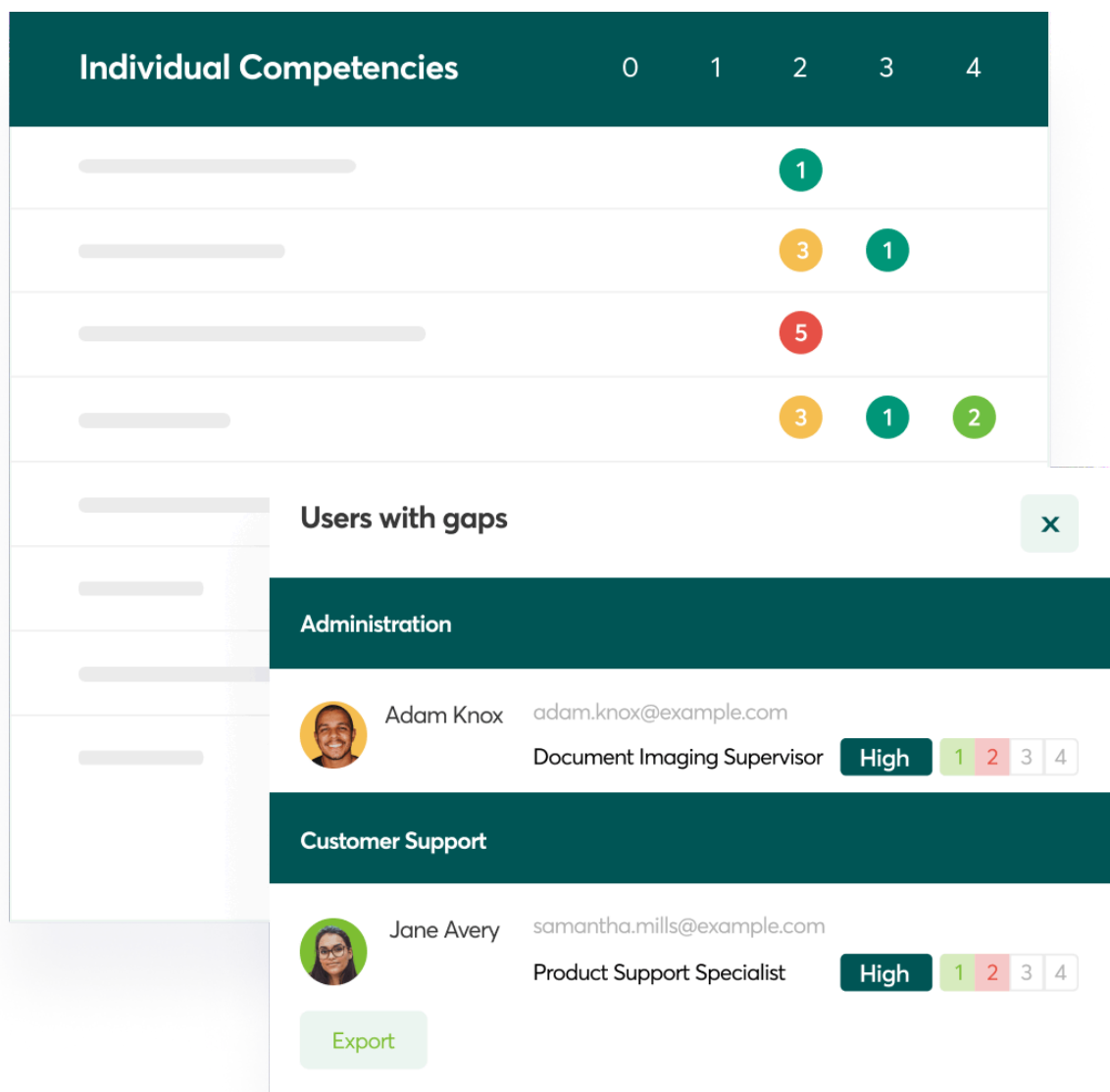
Take a skills-based approach to learning and development and ensure that your organization is maximizing its investment in people.



Business Competencies		0	1	2	3
			★		
				★	★
			★		
Working Experience					
●					

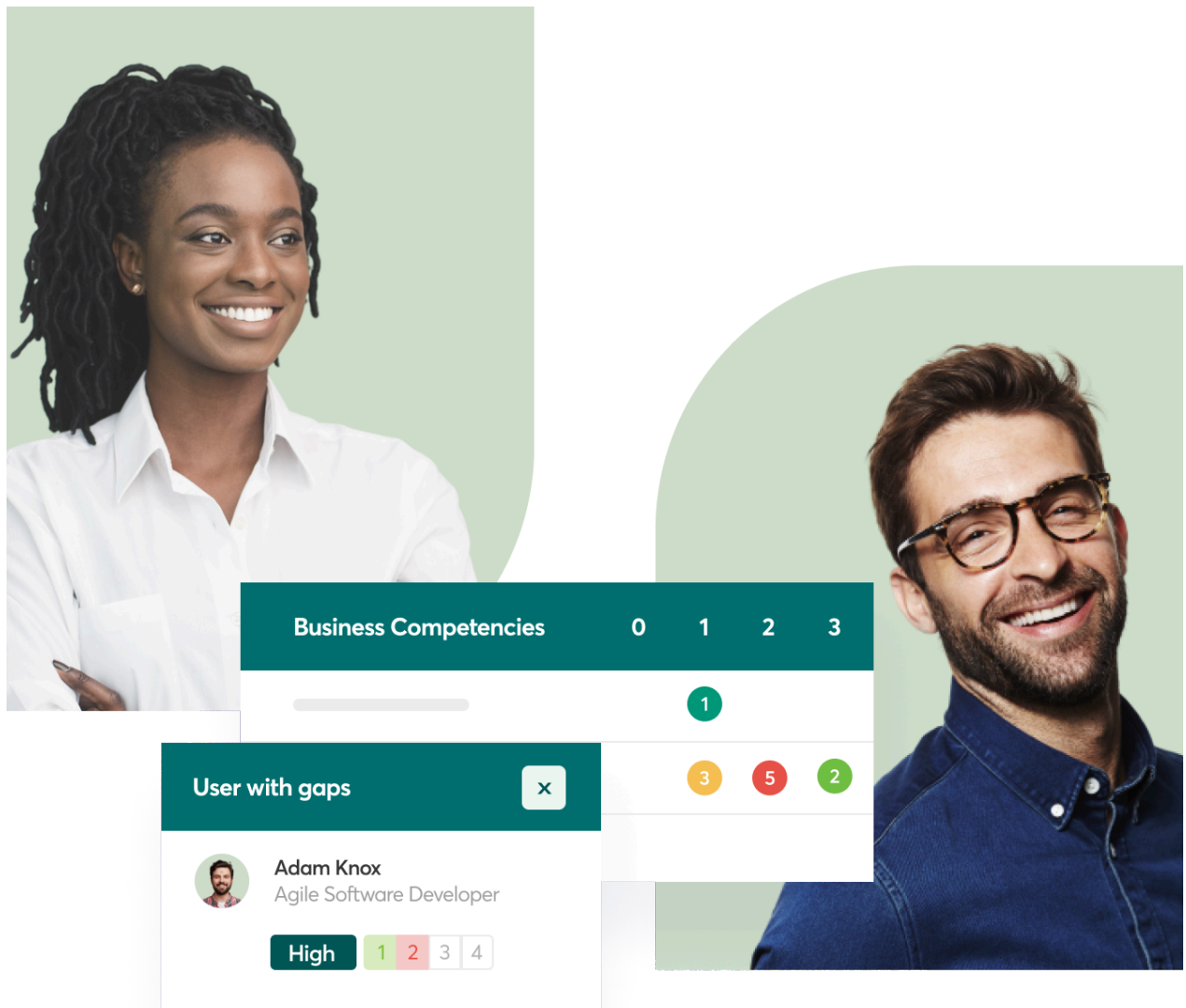
- **Attract and Retain Top Talent**

Upgrade your organization's approach to attraction and retention through an effective career development strategy.



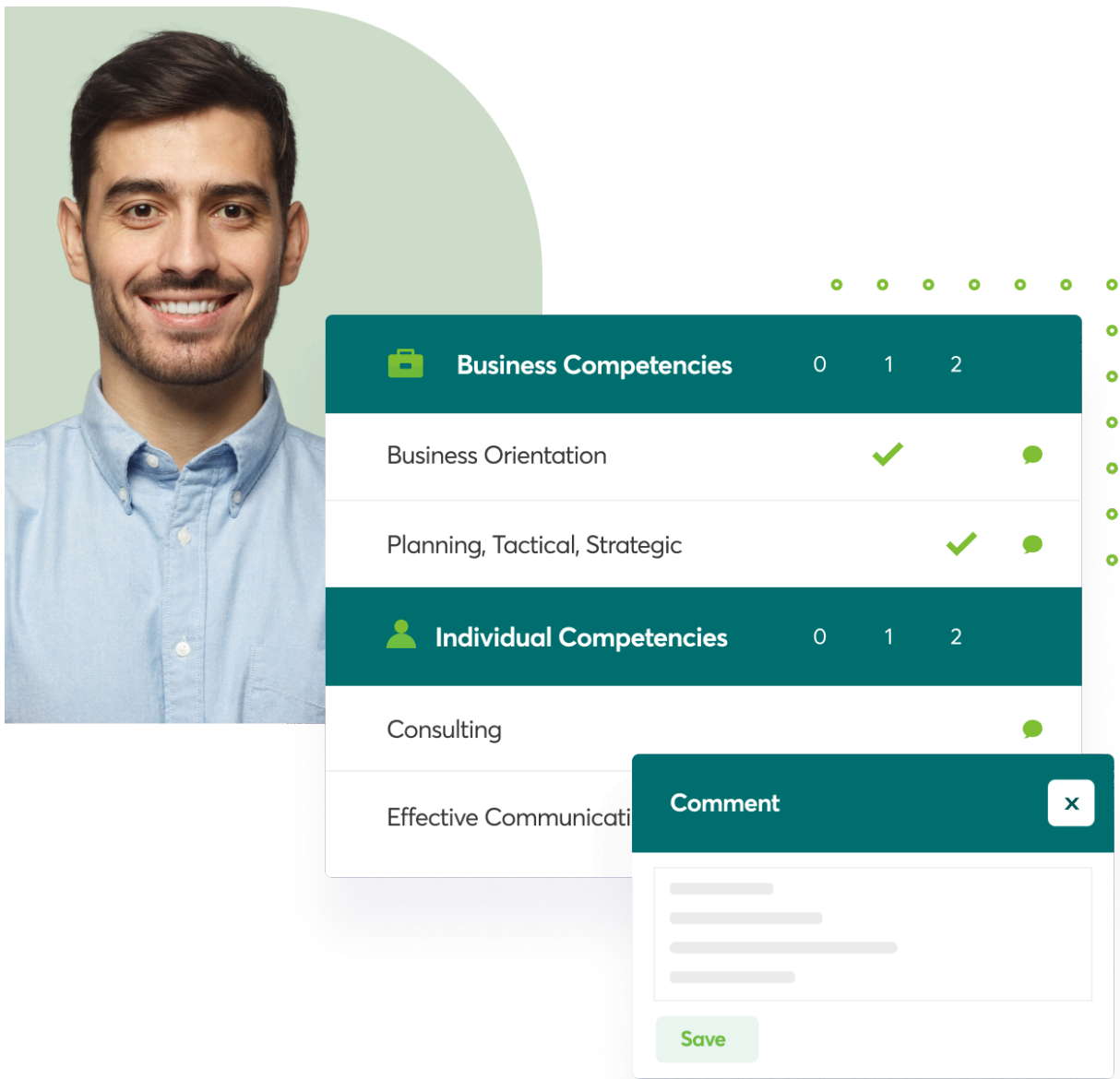
- **Write More Effective Job Descriptions**

Build a stronger foundation for your talent management processes, from recruitment and onboarding through to career development.



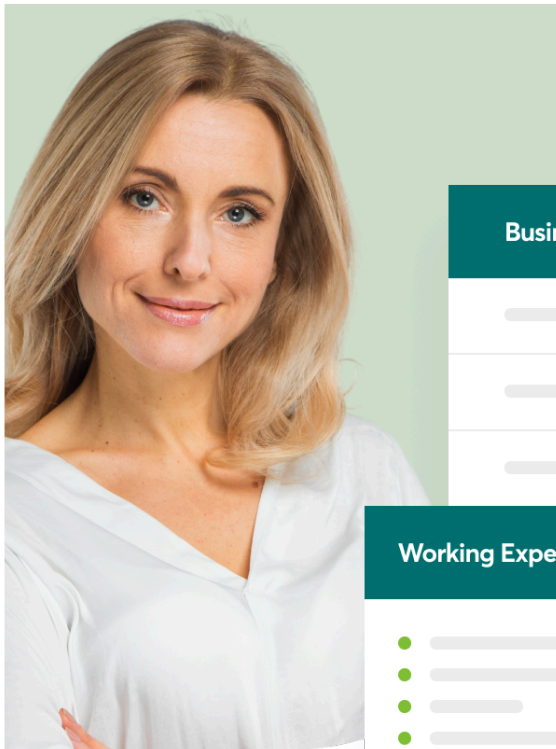
- **Unlock the Potential of Your Workforce**

Capture, identify and analyze the capability of your workforce with a skills-based approach.



- **Maximize Your L&D ROI With Skills Insights**

Take a skills-based approach to learning and development and ensure that your organization is maximizing its investment in people.

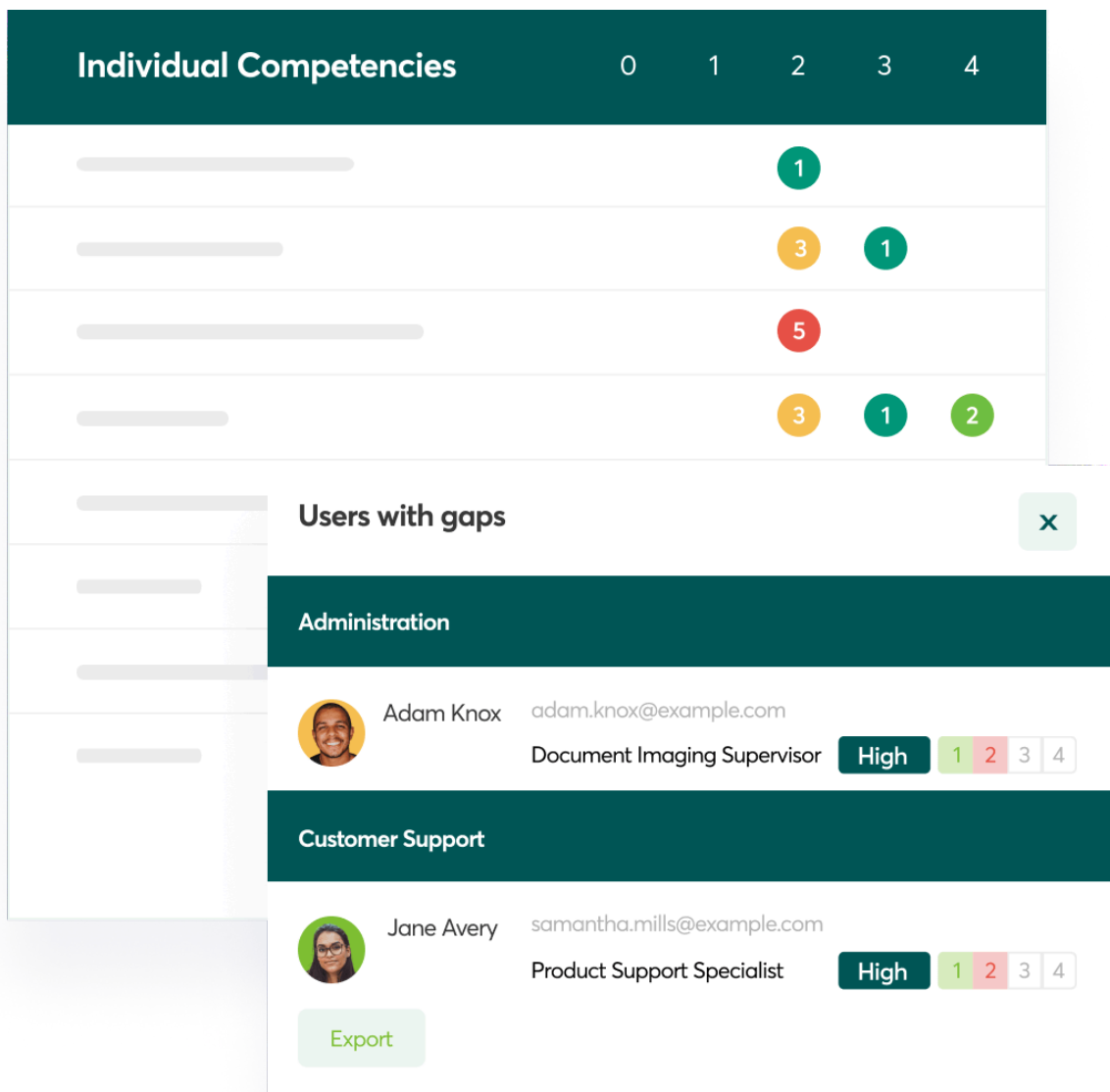


Business Competencies		0	1	2	3
			★		
				★	★
			★		

Working Experience

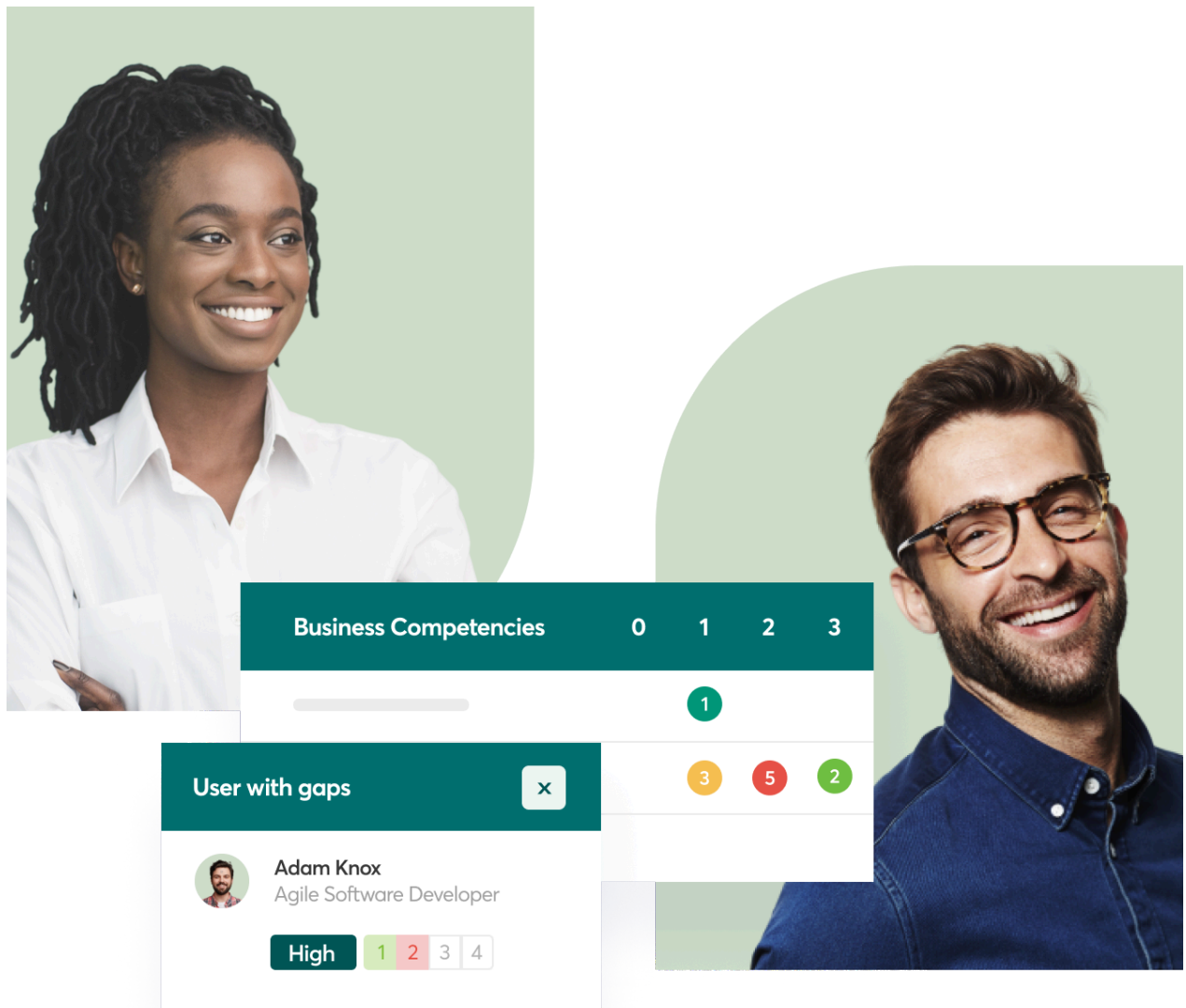
- **Attract and Retain Top Talent**

Upgrade your organization's approach to attraction and retention through an effective career development strategy.



- **Write More Effective Job Descriptions**

Build a stronger foundation for your talent management processes, from recruitment and onboarding through to career development.



Supporting the world's leading workforces

Imperial College
London

 **Electrolux**



Unlock Your Workforce's Full Potential

With Lexonis' AI enhanced software, job and competency libraries and expert consulting services, you can power your success by understanding and developing your workforce's capabilities.

Explore our tailored tools and solutions to streamline competency management and drive your business's growth.

Utilize AI-powered tools to help you build, customize and validate your competency frameworks and job profiles.

[Learn more](#)

Capture assessments and analyze the competencies of your people by using powerful workforce capability and gap analysis views.

[Learn more](#)

As a professional body, attract new members and retain existing ones by providing skill assessments, membership levels and personalized career development plans using a customizable and easily integrated software platform.

[Learn more](#)

Fast track your competency project by leveraging the latest AI-generated job market intelligence in conjunction with industry benchmarked competency definitions and job profile templates from our extensive library.

[Learn more](#)

Partner with our experienced consultants to help you employ AI-tools to fast-track development of your job and competency content; identify the key objectives for your project and begin your journey towards accomplishing them.

[Learn more](#)



Experts in Competency Management Consulting

Our seasoned consultants work across industries, helping HR teams and executives identify key competencies, build talent strategies and implement effective solutions. Whether you're

starting from scratch or optimizing existing systems, we deliver strategies that drive real, measurable business results. Alternatively, we can provide training and solutions to help you to do it yourselves.

With a proven track record of helping organizations large and small, Lexonis' consultants bring unparalleled expertise to every project.



Why Choose Lexonis?

Whether you're an HR manager focusing on employee development or a CEO aligning workforce skills with business strategy, Lexonis is your trusted partner. With [decades of](#)

[experience](#) in competency management, we've been at the forefront longer than anyone else, bringing unmatched expertise to every project.

At Lexonis, we help you understand your employees' strengths, develop their careers and align their skills with your business strategy. Once people see the [software](#), they're wowed. And after experiencing a demo of our solutions, they truly understand its potential.



Your Trusted Frameworks Partner

Whether you are interested in using [Lexonis' job and competency library](#), the [IBM Talent Frameworks](#) library or your own job and skill taxonomies, Lexonis will deliver world-class competency solutions that adapt to your evolving workforce needs. From job profiles to

proficiency levels, our frameworks are designed to help Chief Human Resources Officers (CHROs) and HR Business Partners (HRBPs) stay ahead in the competitive talent landscape.

[Contact us](#)



A Leader in SFIA Solutions

As a [Global SFIA Accredited Partner](#), Lexonis has led the way in developing and delivering competency solutions aligned with the Skills Framework for the Information Age (SFIA). With a deep understanding of every SFIA version, we provide tools and services that keep your organization ahead of the curve when it comes to digital skills.

[Learn more](#)

Dark Web Monitoring Service

Dark Web Monitoring –Proactive Threat Intelligence for Early Warning

Stay Ahead of Hidden Threats.

Core to Cloud's Dark Web Monitoring Service gives you a 24/7 window into the cybercriminal underground. We deliver real-time, targeted threat intelligence specific to your business, so you'll know if hackers are discussing your company, trading your data, or plotting attacks against you before they strike. Unlike generic threat feeds, our insights are highly targeted and actionable, alerting you to danger early and providing guidance to shut down threats at the source.

[Speak to a Cyber Expert](#)



The Invisible Danger

Every day on underground forums, marketplaces, and encrypted chat channels, cybercriminals are quietly trading stolen data, leaked credentials, and access to corporate networks. If your organisation isn't watching the dark web, you're effectively blind to the earliest warning signs of an attack. Ransomware gangs, phishing crews, and insider threat actors often plan their campaigns in the shadows long before they launch. Traditional security tools and firewalls can't defend against threats they can't see coming.

For cybersecurity leaders, this poses a serious challenge: How do you protect your business's reputation and assets when criminals might be selling your information on the dark web right now? Missing these early signals could mean failing to prevent a breach, suffering compliance violations from unnoticed data leaks, and ultimately facing financial and reputational fallout.

[Speak to a cyber expert](#)

Our Dark WebMonitoring Solution

Core to Cloud's fully managed Dark Web Monitoring Service acts as your cyber threat radar in places other defences don't reach. We continuously monitor the hidden corners of the internet where threat actors operate and immediately alert you when your company or employees are mentioned. Our expert team filters out the noise to deliver only relevant,

company-specific intelligence, not the avalanche of irrelevant data typical of generic threat feeds.

Key Features & Capabilities

Real-Time Threat Alerts

Get instant alerts when our monitoring detects chatter or activity targeting your organisation – whether its hackers planning an attack, discussing your systems, or attempting to sell information about your business. Early warning means you can act before a threat escalates.

Stolen Credentials Detection

We'll know if employee or supplier login credentials connected to your company are being sold or shared on dark web markets. Compromised passwords (even those bypassing two-factor authentication) are a common attack path – our service flags them so you can force resets and prevent breaches.

Illicit Access Sale Alerts

Receive notifications if cybercriminals are selling unauthorised access to your network, cloud services, or VPN. This gives you the chance to lock down entry points before those access keys are used for an intrusion.

Phishing & Impersonation Monitoring

We monitor for newly registered domains and postings that suggest bad actors are setting up phishing websites or impersonating your brand. When we spot these, we alert you and can assist with takedown efforts to protect your customers and employees from scams.

Malware Infection Leaks

Our intelligence extends to detecting if any malware in the wild is reporting data from your environment. For example, if an infostealer virus is siphoning credentials or files from one of your machines and dumping them on a dark forum, we'll catch that signal so you can respond quickly.

Supply Chain Visibility

Concerned about your vendors and partners? We also keep an eye on chatter related to your supply chain and third-party partners, giving you insight into indirect threats that could impact you (like a breach at a key supplier that threat actors discuss online).

Actionable Reporting & Guidance

All alerts come with context and recommended actions. We don't just tell you a credential leaked – we'll identify the user or system, explain the potential impact, and advise on remediation (e.g. invalidate accounts, increase monitoring on certain systems, etc.). Regular reports summarise dark web activity relevant to you, helping you communicate risk to stakeholders and take proactive steps.

How It Works

Our Dark Web Monitoring is a fully managed process handled by seasoned threat intelligence analysts and advanced monitoring technology:

[Speak to a cyber expert](#)

Benefits for Your Organisation

Choosing Core to Cloud's Dark Web Monitoring Service delivers peace of mind through unparalleled visibility and early threat detection:

- **Prevent Attacks Before They Happen:** By catching warning signs on the dark web days or weeks in advance, you can stop breaches in their tracks – reset stolen credentials, patch exposed systems, and harden targets before attackers get in. This proactive stance can save millions by avoiding incidents like ransomware or data theft.
- **Protect Your Reputation:** Brand impersonation and data leaks can quietly erode customer trust. Early detection of these issues allows you to take swift action (public statements, legal takedowns, improved security) to protect your brand's reputation. Demonstrating to clients and stakeholders that you monitor even the dark corners of the web shows a deep commitment to security.
- **Improve Incident Response:** Integrating dark web intelligence into your security strategy means that if an incident does occur, you'll have additional context. For example, knowing that employee credentials were posted online helps your incident responders trace intrusion vectors faster. It's an extra layer of insight that can speed up containment and recovery.
- **Ensure Compliance:** Many data protection regulations (like GDPR) and industry standards expect that organisations safeguard personal data. Detecting and remediating leaked data on the dark web helps you stay compliant by promptly addressing breaches or exposures, reducing regulatory risk and potential fines.
- **Holistic Threat Picture:** Our service complements your other security tools (firewalls, SIEM, endpoint protection) by covering an external dimension they cannot. You gain a holistic view of threats, both inside and outside your network. This comprehensive approach closes the vision gap, making your overall cybersecurity program far more robust.

- **Expertise Without the Effort:** Building your own dark web monitoring capability is complex and resource intensive. With our managed service, you immediately gain expert threat intelligence analysts and advanced tools working on your behalf, without adding headcount. Your team gets actionable intel handed to them, with zero drain on your internal resources.

[Speak to a cyber expert](#)



Limited-time offer: Claim your FREE Dark Web scan on your company

Get a glimpse into the murky cybercrime world and how your company and people might be at risk.

Simply provide us a few details, including your company's web domain.

We'll conduct a specialist dark web scan of your company, and deliver you a report... all within 2 business days!

This limited time offer is free of charge. So go on, if you are a CISO or IT team wanting to better protect your company and people, what are you waiting for?

First thing : How Teams Works

I probably didn't explain this properly (I've been working in teams for a long time and missed the obvious) After you submit each assignment :

1. I get a copy of it
2. I edit my comments in
3. When I return it the version in your assignment is replaced with my version.

So never edit it when it's turned in (including via the 'Recents' in Word / Onedrive / Windows)

You need to download the returned version, to carry on with your work.

Aim for today / tomorrow

Get all PPA drafts in

With a Plan

Get started on submitting the PPA & Plan proper

Checking your idea

- Is the title clear and focused on an issue which can be managed:
 - within the timescale, available resources and word total?
 - Do the title and proposed action plan indicate that you will be capable of:
 - investigating and researching the topic or carrying out the activity or task independently?
 - Is there a danger that you will be unable to approach the project impartially and in a balanced way?
 - The Project Proposal forms allow everyone opportunity to check the idea against these criteria
 - PPA : You
 - PPB : Me
 - PPC : CIISec expert panel
 - They can and do reject ideas and ask for new PPAs
-

What does the project need to allow me to include?

Identify, design, plan and complete an individual project, applying a range of **organisational** skills and strategies to meet agreed objectives.

Obtain, critically select and use information from a **range** of sources; analyse data, apply it appropriately and demonstrate understanding of any relevant, connections and complexities of the topic.

Select and use a range of **skills** , including new **technologies** , **solve problems** , take decisions critically, creatively and flexibly, to achieve planned outcomes.

Evaluate outcomes both in relation to agreed objectives, as well as own learning and performance.

Select and use a range of **communication** skills and media to present evidenced outcomes and conclusions in an appropriate format.

Project Proposal Part A: Title of Extended Project

Present the topic to be researched in the form of a short statement / question / hypothesis with clear focus.

Refer to specific points that you would like to examine / evaluate / develop.

You are trying to convince me & CII Sec of the suitability of the project working title.

PPA: Provide a brief outline of the research or activity/ task to be carried out and sources to be consulted with.

What are you doing to find the answer to your question (research, practicals, surveys)

Be detailed – refer to specific sources e.g., a specific book, specific articles etc.

This needs to include specific URLs / Books Papers etc.

Include your links from the RiOP because I think they only print the PPA/B pages.

You are trying to convince us you can find the answer

PPA : Provide a brief outline of the course of study or area(s) to which the topic relates

Refer directly to which particular **CyberEPQ module** and what aspect of it you are seeking to develop and how you plan to do that.

You are trying to convince me / CiiSEC that your question is relevant to and extends/develops from the CyberEPQ Modules.

PPA : Provide a brief outline of any specific resources and/or equipment you may require, as appropriate

Be specific.

If you need the Paloalto boxes, a safe network or other hardware or software list it.

You are trying to convince me / _ CiiSEC _ that you have thought about the stuff you might need (from hardware to questionnaire software etc.)

PPA : Provide a brief outline of your proposed action

Be specific

Refer to any cyber professionals/ experts who you may intend to contact and for what purpose;

Any surveys that you intend to conduct and what you will do with your findings.

Provide a brief outline of how you plan to further your project **perhaps month by month** . Or refer to your full plan / GANTT Chart

You are trying to convince me / CiiSEC that your project / research plan is feasible.

Project Proposal Part B

This is to be completed by the supervisor.

The supervisor should comment on :-

- the suitability of the project working title,
 - how the project proposal extends/develops from the learner's main course of study,
 - and whether the learner's research plan is feasible.
-

Show the development of your CyberEPQ

The Lead Moderator says : marks were lost due to lack of evidence in showing the development of the CyberEPQ.

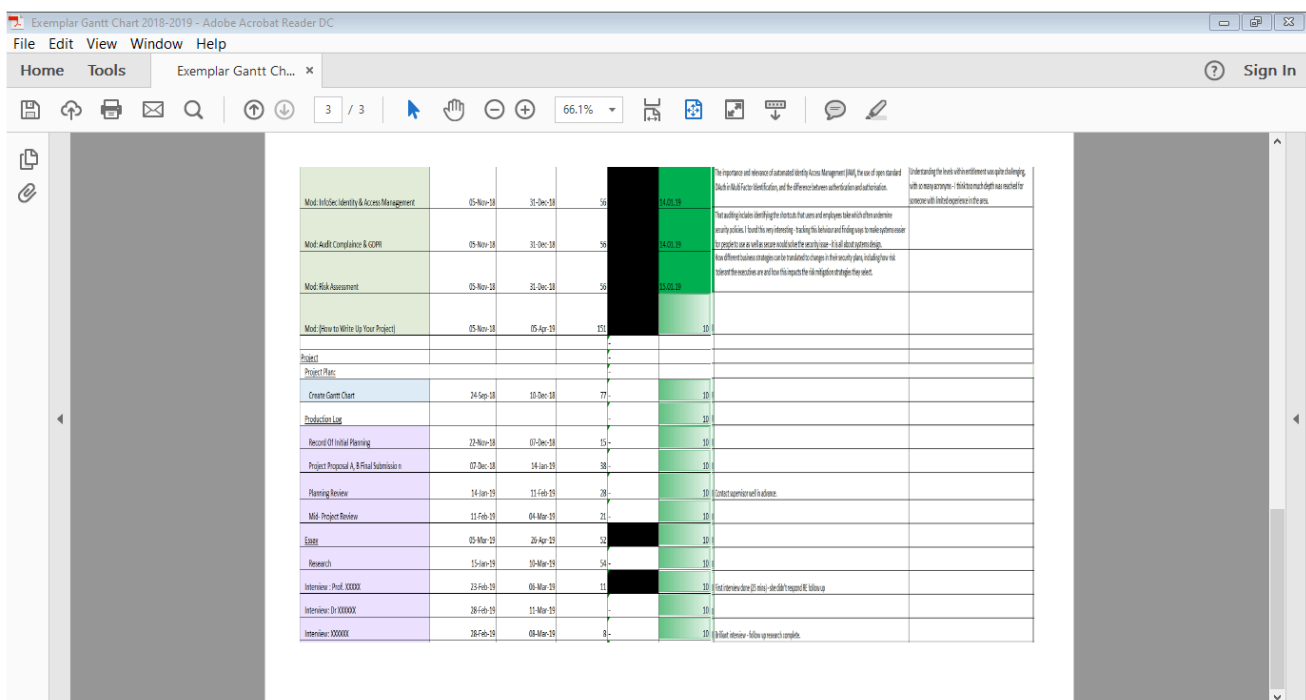
A Gantt chart is one way of doing this and good place for instruction of how to do this with reference to EPQ's in general can be found on YouTube.

A good project plan or Gantt chart could help keep your learners aware of deadlines and keep them on track and making progress.

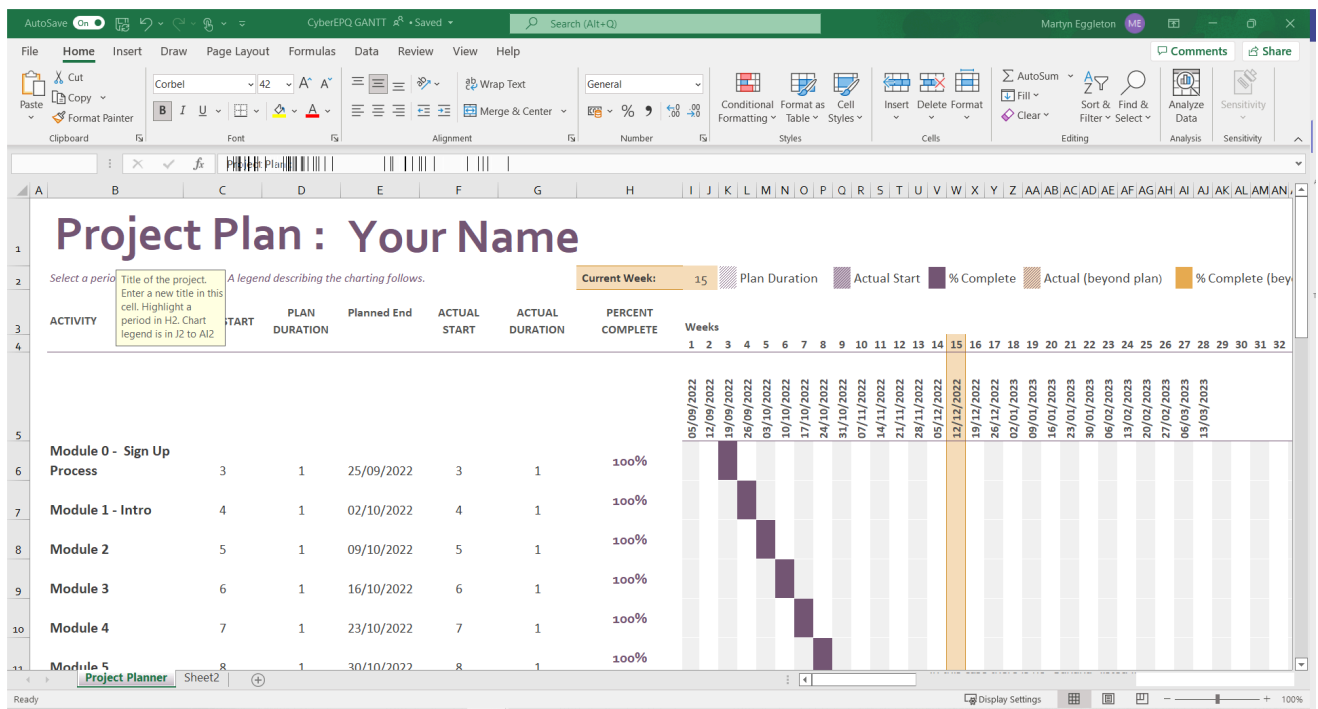
The EPQ is a project based qualification of 120 hours work and it is **not only** an essay that can be written over a period of a week or less.

Planning

They say they like GANTT charts, but this isn't a GANTT chart.



This is also not a GANTT Chart but.....



This mermaid chart is in the “Markdown Planning Techniques.md”

